

If the four hypothetical Data Records shown above were the complete NIPS file, then that NIPS file would contain eight records. The first Data Record (A) would have two records, the second Data Record (B) would have only one record, the third Data Record (C) would have three records, and the fourth Data Record (D) would have two records.

For the translated files, each record has a fixed length of 187 record positions. Each record includes the record positions for the fixed set and for the periodic set. The data for the fixed set is always present within each translated record and specific fields within the fixed set known as the control set serve as the unique identifier for each record. The first instances of the periodic set are found in the translated record. Additional instances of the periodic set data are written to additional records but with the same fixed set data as the first instance. Using the hypothetical NIPS file shown above, the eight NIPS records would become five translated records. The new arrangement would be:

Translated Record 1 = Fixed Set A + Periodic Set #1 A1
Translated Record 2 = Fixed Set B
Translated Record 3 = Fixed Set C + Periodic Set #1 C1
Translated Record 4 = Fixed Set C + Periodic Set #1 C2
Translated Record 5 = Fixed Set D + Periodic Set #1 D1

Record Layout.

NWME created a record layout for the translation data file using the element format (field definitions / File Format Table) in the KHMER NIPS file and the agency documentation. The record layout (Folder 2, Translation File Record Layout) contains the Column Name, Title / Description, Data Type, Start Position, End Position, and Column Width. The last column in the record layout text file named "LINE-END" was not derived from the NIPS file or agency documentation and was added during the translation process. The "LINE-END" column accounts for two characters that were inserted at the end of each record (Record Positions 188 – 189) in the translation data file when it was originally copied to CDR before preservation copying. The two characters, indicating the end of a record, were not transferred to the preservation copy of the translation data file. The record length of the translation data file is a total of 187 record positions as indicated in the element format (field definitions / File Format Table) of the NIPS file and the agency documentation. The table below depicts the record layout of the KHMER translation data file. The location of the columns in the control set, fixed set, and periodic set are indicated on the left.

Set	Column Name	Title	Data Type	Start Position	End Position	Width
Control	MSGDATE	Message Date	VARCHAR2	1	6	6
	ITEMNO	Item Number	VARCHAR2	7	8	2
Fixed	FLG1	ARVN Flag	VARCHAR2	9	9	1
	FLG2	Second Flag	VARCHAR2	10	10	1
	FLG3_FLG4	Third & Fourth Flags	VARCHAR2	11	18	8
	MRSD	Military Region Subdivision	VARCHAR2	19	22	4

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Set	Column Name	Title	Data Type	Start Position	End Position	Width
	ADCT	Conversion Code	VARCHAR2	23	23	1
	ADCR	Military / Political Subdivision Code	VARCHAR2	24	26	3
	INCDATE	Incident Date	VARCHAR2	27	32	6
	QTR	Quarter	VARCHAR2	33	36	4
	HY	Half Year	VARCHAR2	37	40	4
	INIT	Initiator	VARCHAR2	41	41	1
	EF	Initiator Code	VARCHAR2	42	42	1
	IAC	Initiator Activity	VARCHAR2	43	44	2
	OBJECT	Objective	VARCHAR2	45	46	2
	RACT	Recipient Activity	VARCHAR2	47	48	2
	EWEAP	Enemy Weapon	VARCHAR2	49	50	2
	FACT	Friendly Activity	VARCHAR2	51	52	2
	EACT	Enemy Activity	VARCHAR2	53	54	2
	UTM	Universal Transverse Mercator	VARCHAR2	55	62	8
	CORD	Coordinate	VARCHAR2	63	77	15
	LATLONG	Latitude / Longitude	VARCHAR2	78	92	15
	ITIME	Incident Time	VARCHAR2	93	96	4
	WK	Week	VARCHAR2	97	100	4
	FNUMB	Friendly Unit Number	VARCHAR2	101	103	3
	FTYPE	[Friendly] Unit Type	VARCHAR2	104	104	1
	FSIZE	[Friendly Unit] Size	VARCHAR2	105	105	1
	FNAT	Friendly [Unit] Nationality	VARCHAR2	106	106	1
	ESIZE	Enemy [Unit] Size	VARCHAR2	107	107	1
	ENAT	Enemy [Unit] Nationality	VARCHAR2	108	108	1
	LOCNM	Location Name	VARCHAR2	109	123	15
	COMMENT	Comment	VARCHAR2	124	135	12
Periodic	SETCD	Casualty Code	VARCHAR2	136	136	1
	SETEF	Casualty Code	VARCHAR2	137	137	1
	ASSOC	Casualty Nationality	VARCHAR2	138	143	6
	KIA	Killed	NUMBER	144	146	3
	WIA	Wounded	NUMBER	147	149	3
	CAP	Captured / Missing	NUMBER	150	152	3
	RAL	Rallied	NUMBER	153	155	3
	PERCOM	Periodic Comments	VARCHAR2	156	187	32

Original Data Editing and Verification.

During the Vietnam conflict subject matter specialists transcribed the KHMER data onto keypunch coding sheets. Then keypunch operators used these coding sheets to produce the KHMER punch cards. The computer used the punch cards, together with the FFS programs to create the KHMER file for NIPS.

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